

Neighbors,

As Minneapolis reimagines community safety and racial justice, here is a compilation of resources that might assist our transformation.

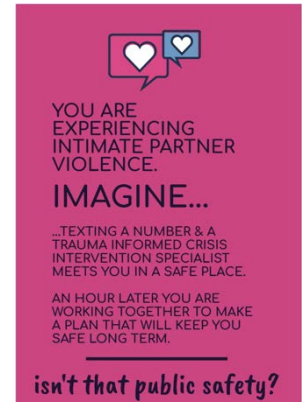
The kind of change that builds community resiliency—rather than exacerbating racism, scarcity, and incarceration—starts at home!

Sincerely,

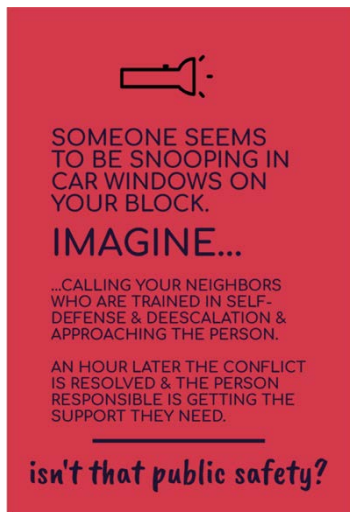
Your neighbor in Longfellow.

WHAT IS COMMUNITY SAFETY?

*"Imagine that you were asked to help create stability in a newly-founded city. How would you try to solve the problems that your friends and neighbors encountered? How would you respond to crisis and violence? Would your *first* choice be an unaccountable army with a history of oppression and violence patrolling your neighborhood around the clock?" (3)*



Graphics by Syenite (5)



"Never forget: an inconvenience for one person, once police are involved, can become a death sentence for another person." (3)



"Calling the police often escalates situations, puts people at risk, and leads to violence. Anytime you seek help from the police, you're inviting them into your community and putting people who may already be vulnerable into dangerous situations. Sometimes people feel that calling the police is the only way to deal with problems. But we can build trusted networks of mutual aid that allow us to better handle conflicts ourselves and move toward forms of transformative justice, while keeping police away from our neighborhoods." (1)

"Obviously, in some situations, calling police may still occur. But by understanding the often dire consequences of calling them in, we can be a lot more mindful about whether circumstances truly demand it." (7)



WHAT TO DO INSTEAD OF CALLING THE POLICE

“**Check your impulse** to call the police on someone you believe looks or is acting ‘suspicious.’ Is their race, gender, ethnicity, class, or housing situation influencing your choice? Such calls can be death sentences for many people.” (2)

“**If you DO need police, go to them** instead of calling them to you” (3) For example, “if something of yours is stolen and you need to file a report for insurance or other purposes, consider going to the police station instead of bringing cops into your community. You may inadvertently be putting someone in your neighborhood at risk.” (2)

“**Don’t feel obligated to defend property**—especially corporate ‘private’ property. Before confronting someone or contacting the police, ask yourself if anyone is being hurt or endangered by property “theft” or damage. If the answer is ‘no,’ then let it be.” (2)

“With **mental health crises**, remember to center the person in crisis” (3) “If you observe someone exhibiting behavior that seems ‘odd’ to you, don’t assume that they are publicly intoxicated. A traumatic brain injury or a similar medical episode may be occurring. Ask if they are OK, if they have a medical condition, and if they need assistance.” (2)

Consider:

- “What resources are available to help? Does the person have medications that will be helpful? Are there ‘safe places’ to go?
- Is the hospital a good option? Is there a safe inpatient facility in your area that they are willing to go to?
- Are there hotlines to call that can help? (Be aware, however, that some suicide hotlines will call the police if they feel there is imminent danger.)
- If you don’t have a car, is there someone that does who can help with transportation?
- Does the person in crisis have a therapist who helps them?” (4)

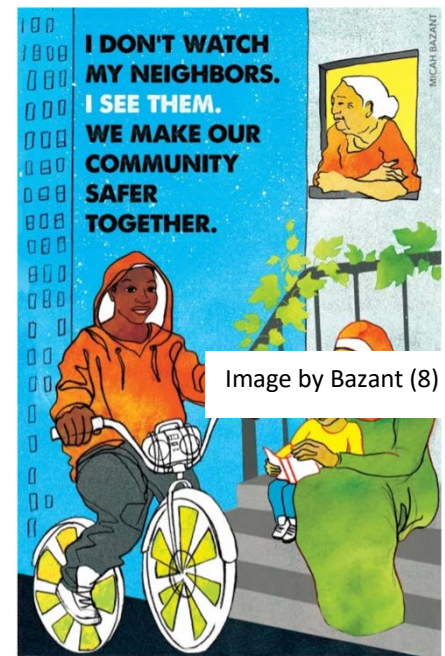


Image by Bazant (8)

“If you see someone pulled over with **car trouble**, stop and ask if they need help or if you can call a tow truck for them. If the police are introduced to such a situation, they may give punitive and unnecessary tickets to people with car issues, target those without papers, or worse.” (2)

“Keep a contact **list of community resources** like suicide hotlines. When police are contacted to ‘manage’ such situations, people with mental illness are sixteen times more likely to be killed by cops than those without mental health challenges.” (2)

“Encourage teachers, coworkers, and organizers to **avoid inviting police into classrooms**, workplaces, and public spaces. Instead, create for a culture of taking care of each other and not unwittingly putting people in harm’s way. If you’re part of a group that’s holding a rally or demonstration, don’t get a permit or otherwise cooperate with the police.” (2)

“If your neighbor is having a party and the **noise is bothering you**, go over and talk to them. Getting to know your neighbors with community events like monthly block parties is a good way to make asking them to quiet down a little less uncomfortable, or to find another neighbor who is willing to do so.” (2)

“If you see someone **peeing in public**, just look away! Remember, for example, that many houseless people do not have reliable access to bathrooms.” (2)

“Hold and attend de-escalation, conflict resolution, first-aid, volunteer medic, and self-defense **workshops in your neighborhood**, school, workplace, or community organization.” (2) “The more skills we have to share with our neighbors and family, the less we have to rely on unaccountable armed paramilitary forces!” (3)

“**Don’t report graffiti** and street artists. If you see work that includes fascistic or hate speech, paint over it yourself or with friends.” (2)

“Remember that **police can escalate domestic violence** situations. You can support friends and neighbors who are being victimized by abusers by offering them a place to stay, a ride to a safe location, or to watch their children. Utilize community resources like safe houses and hotlines.” (2)



(6)

WHO TO CALL INSTEAD OF POLICE: LOCAL RESOURCES

"Crime isn't random. Most of the time, it happens when someone has been unable to meet their basic needs through other means. By shifting money away from the police and toward services that actually meet those needs, we'll be able to get to a place where people won't need to rob banks.

Sure, in this long transition process, we may need a small specialized class of public servants whose job it is to respond to violent crimes. But part of what we're talking about here is what role police play in our society. Right now, cops don't just respond to violent crimes; they make needless traffic stops, arrest petty drug users, and engage in a wide range of 'broken windows policing' behaviors that only serve to keep more people under the thumb of the criminal justice system." (9)

2-1-1: *call, text, or chat with your local 211 to speak with a community resource specialist in your area to help you find services and resources, such as supplemental food and nutrition programs; shelter and housing options; utilities assisting, disaster relief; employment and education opportunities; veterans' services; vaccination and health epidemic info; addiction prevention and rehab programs; reentry for ex-offenders; special needs and mental health support groups; and safe paths out of domestic abuse.*

Community Outreach for Psychiatric Emergencies (COPE): *mobile crisis team will come to the location of a person in crisis. 612-596-1223*

Canvas Health's Crisis Connection: *counselor will speak to a person via phone. 612-379-6363 or 866-379-6363*

Communities United Against Police Brutality (CUAPB): *24-hour hotline available to report instances of police abuse. 612-874-7867*

Crisis Text Line: *text SHARE to 74174 for free, confidential crisis counseling 24/7.*

Minnesota Adult Abuse Reporting Center: *report instances of abuse enacted toward vulnerable adults. 844-880-1574*

Hennepin County Child Protection Services: *report instances of child abuse. 612-348-3552 + Press 1 to report.*

Hennepin County Front Door Access: *support line to assist in access to county services. 612-348-4111*

Longfellow Community Council (LCC): *has resources to support our vulnerable residents. Email info@longfellow.org*

St. Paul & Ramsey County Domestic Abuse Intervention Project: *crisis support can offer resources and advice.* 651-645-2824 / Toll-free: 888-575-3367

Red Door Clinic: *can provide Narcan for opioid overdose.* 612-543-5555

Minnesota Poison Control: *call to request immediate transport to medical facility on suspicion of poison.* 1-800-222-1222

St. Stephen's Street Outreach Team: *provides first contact for individuals experiencing homelessness; call if you feel concerned about a homeless neighbor's well-being.* 612-879-7624

The Bridge for Youth: *crisis intervention and shelter, LGBTQ+ friendly.* 612-377-8800; Text 612-400-SAFE (7233)

Sexual Violence Center Serving Hennepin, Carver, and Scott Counties: *support crisis line for survivors, friends, and family.* 612-871-5111 or 952-448-5425

City of Minneapolis Language Lines: Spanish: 612-673-2700; Somali: 612-673-3500; Hmong: 612-673-2800



VISION FOR THE LONG-TERM

“Build community all the time, not just in times of trouble. It isn’t just about building capacity as individuals; it’s about cultivating resilient communities. One of the first steps we can take toward communities that no longer need police is meeting one another. We can know our neighbors’ names. We can hold potlucks, volunteer to help our neighbors with simple things like shoveling snow or carrying groceries, and build real relationships. That way, when crises happen, we have other resources to call upon besides the police” (3)



“Reallocate resources from police to services that truly help people....divest from police while investing in communities.”

(3)

(6)

“Engage in policy work that can **prevent, rather than just punish, crime**. When we ask people ‘what keeps your community healthy and safe?’ the answers we hear are often very similar: affordable housing, jobs, youth programs, opportunities to create and experience art, welcoming parks, etc. We can cultivate safer and healthier neighborhoods by getting involved in activist organizations, neighborhood groups, school boards, etc. that have the power to do this preventative work.” (3)

FOR MORE LEARNING

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(9)

“many people who think police abolition is crazy actually live in a world where the police have effectively been abolished already. If they want to know what a world looks like without police, all they have to do is look around them. Just ask white folks who are of some privilege: Do you generally have encounters with the police? How often do you see the police? The answer is very little. [...] The world we’re trying to build already exists. It just doesn’t exist for us” –Ta-Nehisi Coates (10)

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